Saint Columban College
College of Computing Studies
Pagadian City

# Back to History

**Challenge Name:** Back to History

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|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Category: | General Information | Level: | basic | Created At: | 9 years ago |
| Tries: | 21136 Times | Solved: | 10775 Times | Points: | 25 |

**Difficulty Level**

Basic — Advanced

**Rating**

★★★★★

**Challenge Description**

am the First Computer Virus ever known . My name is .....?

**Author:** The Analyst: Hyposelenia

**Challenge:** Back to History

**Category:** General information

**Date:** 04/02/26

I. Objective

To identify the first known computer virus in history.

II. Background

The first widely recognized self-replicating program in computing history is Creeper, created in the early 1970s. It was developed by Bob Thomas at BBN Technologies.

Creeper was designed as an experimental program that moved across systems on the ARPANET, displaying the message: *"I'm the creeper, catch me if you can!"* It marked the beginning of self-propagating software and influenced later developments in malware.

III. Tool Used

- **Search Browser -** Used to search information

IV. Methodology

1. Searched for the first computer virus in history
2. Identified the earliest known self-replicating program
3. Submitted the answer

V. Result

**Creeper**

VI. Explanation

Although Creeper is often referred to as the "first computer virus," it is **technically a worm, not a virus**.

A **virus** requires user action and attaches itself to a host file or program to spread.

A **worm**, on the other hand, is self-replicating and spreads automatically across networks without needing a host file.

Creeper behaved like a worm because it moved independently across systems on ARPANET without attaching to other files. Therefore, while commonly called a virus in general discussions, it is more accurately classified as the first **computer worm**.

This distinction is important in cybersecurity, as it highlights different propagation methods used by malicious software.

## VII. Conclusion

By researching early computing history and understanding malware classifications, the correct answer—Creeper—was identified as the first known self-replicating program, more accurately a worm than a virus.

— **The Analyst: Hyposelenia**